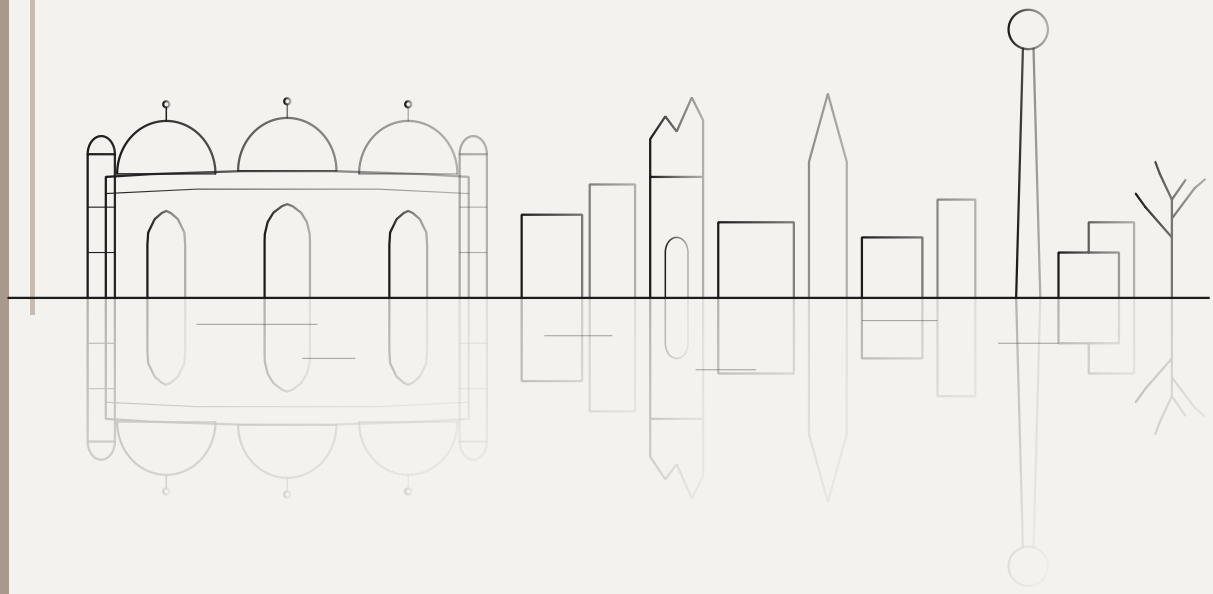


PORTFOLIO

Architecture & Cultural Heritage

Priyati Golder

2018 – 2025

SELECTED WORKS

HALLE (SAALE), GERMANY

INTRODUCTION

Priyati Golder

priyati.kuad@gmail.com

For me, architecture begins with people and place.

I see every project as a conversation between the people who will use a space, the character of its site, and the possibilities of material and light. Good architecture, I believe, does not need to shout; it quietly supports everyday life and is built to last.

I work across scales, from the detail of a joint to the shape of a neighbourhood, moving between sketches, drawings and models to test ideas. Research and close observation of context are part of how I design, not separate from it.

I value buildings that are honest in their construction, responsive to climate and culture, and open to change over time. This portfolio presents a selection of projects that reflect this way of thinking.

SELECTED WORKS

CONTENTS

FIVE PROJECTS



Restorey

Adaptive transformation of a war-damaged building, Berlin 04



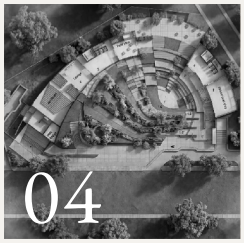
Church Redesign

A sacred space, reimagined 12



Interwoven

Integrating heritage into the urban fabric, Mymensingh 20



Encore

A cultural centre to nurture the art of Jatrapala 24

IMAGE

05

Half-Timber Architecture

An analysis of timber-frame buildings in Germany 28

01

Restorey

The Adaptive Transformation of Berlin's War-Damaged Infrastructure to a Changing Cityscape

PROJECT	Master's Thesis · "Resilience and Renewal"
MENTORS	Prof. Dr. Rudolf Lückmann & Architect von Ey
YEAR	September 2025
LOCATION	Kärntener Straße 26, Berlin-Schöneberg, Germany

CONTEXT

Kärntener Straße 26 is a Gründerzeit corner building from 1899, originally five storeys high with a roof floor and decorated gables. During the Second World War, its corner section lost two floors and its roof and was covered with a temporary roof. Today the corner stands only three storeys high, leaving a gap in the street wall of an otherwise continuous residential street.

APPROACH

The project asked two questions: could more housing and a commercial ground floor make economically efficient use of the existing building, and could rebuilding the lost floors and roof with contemporary materials restore the street wall? Historical maps, the 1899 plans, on-site observation and a review of planning regulations informed a design model that was developed step by step.

DESIGN

The design treats the damaged building not as a ruin to be preserved but as an incomplete structure to be continued. Working entirely within the existing fabric, without demolition, every floor was redesigned through an iterative model tested against the two research questions. The two lost corner floors are rebuilt and the attic is converted into a roof floor, increasing the number of flats from 24 to 28 while keeping their original size. The corner, once a void, becomes the building's public face: a restaurant visible from two streets opens into the formerly unused courtyard, now a shared space for residents. New balconies give every street-facing room a connection to the neighbourhood, and a rhythm of gables abstracted from the 1899 façade completes the roofline.

The building returns to the height of its neighbours and to its 1899 floor area, closing the gap left by the war with a new look inspired by its traditional appearance.



AERIAL VIEW The rebuilt corner with its new roof floor and gables restores the height of the block and closes the gap in the street wall



SITE · BERLIN-SCHÖNEBERG

Kärntener Straße 26

Connecting entry road

01 · RESTOREY

Closing the Gap

The corner, before and after

In 1899 the corner stood five storeys high with a roof floor and decorated gables. War damage reduced it to three storeys under a temporary roof. The design rebuilds the two lost floors and the roof, returning the corner to the height of its neighbours.



BEFORE Three storeys and a temporary roof: a gap in the street wall



AFTER Rebuilt floors and roof restore the height of the street

Site and Context

Schöneberg around Kärntener Straße



HISTORICAL MAPS Schöneberg in 1879, 1901 and 1912, with the project site marked in yellow



LANDMARKS Places around the project site, numbered as in the text

1 Rudolph-Wilde-Park

An urban oasis laid out between 1906 and 1914 around the U-Bahn station Rathaus Schöneberg, offering a peaceful green ribbon loved by locals for walking, reading and playing boules.

2 Rathaus Schöneberg

Seat of West Berlin's government from 1949 to 1990, office of the Governing Mayor and meeting place of the House of Representatives, and a global symbol of the divided city's desire for freedom.

• Project site

Kärntener Straße 26

3 Innsbrucker Platz

A key transport hub since the opening of its U-Bahn and S-Bahn stations, linking central Berlin with the city's southern districts.

4 Dominicus-Sportplatz

A sports ground with a football pitch, athletics track and seating for around 4,500 spectators, established in 1920 and modernised in 2019/2020.

5 Natur-Park Schöneberger Südgelände

A former railway yard turned nature reserve and art park, where wild vegetation grows among tracks, a steam locomotive and a water tower.

From Existing to Proposed

Rebuilding within the existing fabric

The existing plans show the building as it stands today: the corner reduced to three storeys, with an unused courtyard behind it. In the proposed ground floor, the corner opens as a restaurant visible from two streets and connected to the courtyard, which becomes a shared green space for residents. The original structure and flat sizes are kept, while the two rebuilt floors and the new roof floor increase the number of flats from 24 to 28.



GROUND FLOOR · 1899 The original layout



GROUND FLOOR · TODAY After war damage and later changes



GROUND FLOOR · PROPOSED

Restaurant at the corner, opening into the shared courtyard

The Roofline

Gables abstracted from the 1899 façade

The 1899 façade was crowned by a rhythm of decorated gables, lost with the war damage to the corner. The new design takes this rhythm as its starting point: the gables are studied, simplified and repeated, then placed along the new roof floor. They complete the roofline of the street again, in a contemporary language that recalls the building's original character.

FRONT ELEVATION

FRONT ELEVATION The street façade with the rebuilt corner and new roof floor

GABLE STUDIES

GABLE STUDY From the historic gable to its abstracted form, and variations tested along the roofline







VIEWS The new design for Kärntener Straße 26: a restaurant on the ground floor, residential floors above, and the rebuilt upper floors and roof. Above: street view at dusk. Below: the new gables and the roof floor at sunset.

02

Church Redesign

A sacred space, reimagined

PROJECT	Academic · Master's Studio
MENTOR	Prof. Dr. Rudolf Lückmann
YEAR	2024
LOCATION	St. Bartholomäi, Zerbst, Saxony-Anhalt, Germany

This project transforms St. Bartholomäi in Zerbst into a place that serves both worship and community life. Inside the historic walls, a new timber structure inspired by the form of trees creates an open, light-filled interior, without touching the historic fabric.

CONTEXT

At the heart of Zerbst, the ruined nave of St. Bartholomäi stands open to the sky, while the town lacks shared places where people can meet. The project brings these two together: the task was to design within this historic setting, respecting its character while giving the church a new role in everyday community life.

CONCEPT

The building is conceived as both a place of worship and a welcoming, inclusive space for the whole community. Its programme follows three rhythms of use:

Daily	Prayer, community library, co-working and coffee shop
Weekly	Sunday worship, after-school programmes, community classes in arts and parenting, and support groups
Seasonal	Holiday markets and youth camps

DESIGN

The key principle was to add new structure without touching the old. A free-standing timber structure, shaped like branching trees, rises inside the historic walls and carries a new roof, recalling the rhythm of Gothic vaults in a contemporary material. The altar is moved to the centre of the nave so the space gathers around it. A new upper floor houses a community library, a quiet place for reading above the busy gathering space below. A ramp connects the two levels, making the whole building universally accessible, while kitchen and toilets sit at the sides to keep the central space open.



02 Aerial view: St. Bartholomäi within the historic town centre of Zerbst



01

02 · CHURCH REDESIGN

Existing Condition

A roofless nave in the heart of Zerbst

HISTORY

St. Bartholomäi was badly damaged during the Second World War. While the choir was later repaired and is still used as the winter church, the nave remains a roofless ruin. This open nave is the space where the new intervention takes place, inside the ruin, without touching its historic fabric.

TODAY

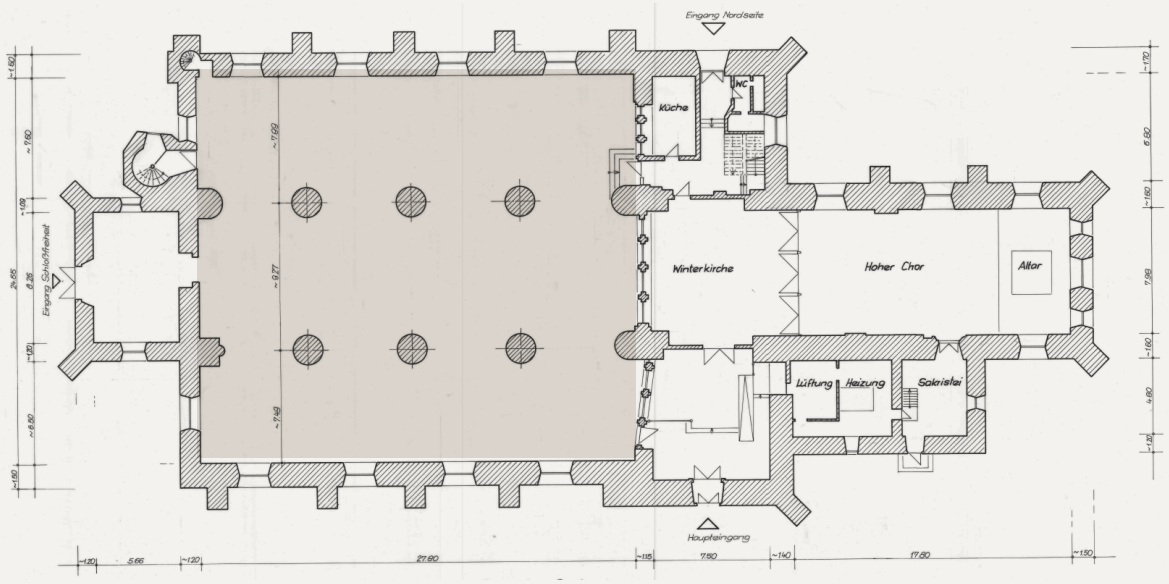
Six round brick columns still carry the pointed arcades that once divided the nave into three aisles. The outer walls of brick and fieldstone stand to their full height, and the massive west wall closes the space. Without a roof, the nave has become an open, paved courtyard: impressive in scale, but exposed to the weather.

IMAGES

01 The roofless nave looking west

02 The fieldstone west wall

03 The repaired eastern part, seen from the nave



EXISTING GROUND FLOOR The roofless nave is shaded



02



03

Proposed Ground Floor

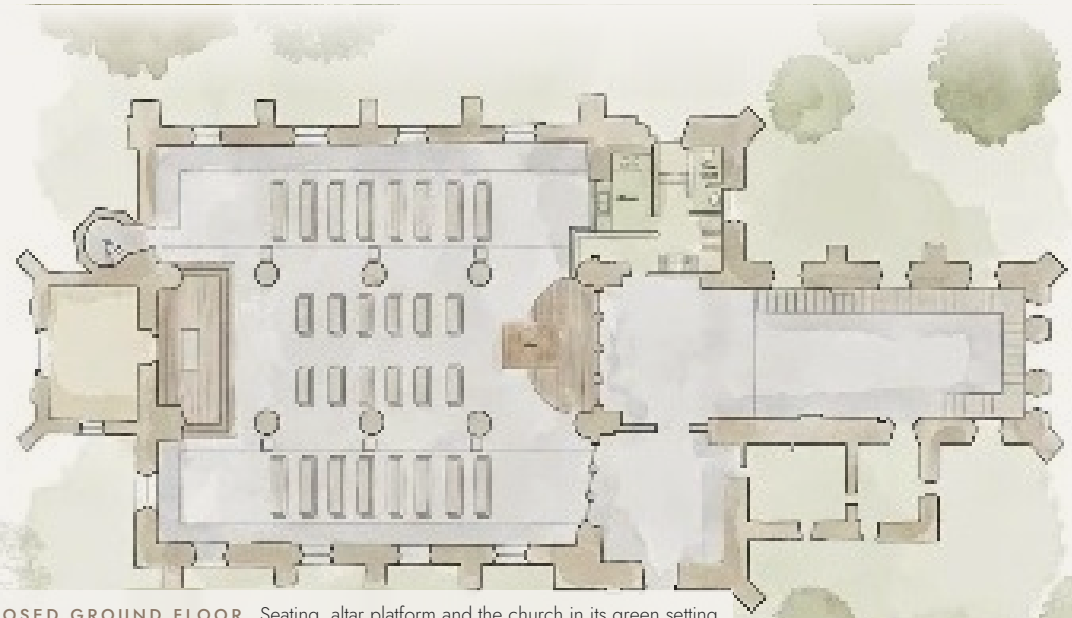
One shared hall inside the ruin

LAYOUT

The nave becomes one shared hall for worship and community events. Rows of seating face a new semicircular altar platform at the east end of the nave, under the arch to the winter church, placing the altar at the centre of the whole church. Kitchen and toilets sit in the north-east corner, keeping the hall open.

PLANS

Both plans are shown at the same scale and on the same axis, so the existing and proposed layouts can be compared directly.



PROPOSED GROUND FLOOR Seating, altar platform and the church in its green setting

The Timber Structure

A forest inside the ruin

IDEA

The new structure is inspired by the form of a tree. Each timber column rises from the floor of the nave like a trunk and divides into branches beneath the roof. Placed in rows that follow the line of the existing columns, these "trees" form a forest inside the historic walls, an organic counterpart to the heavy masonry of the ruin.

FORM

At the top, curved timber ribs branch outwards like a crown. The ribs of neighbouring trees cross and overlap, forming a canopy of pointed arches that recalls the Gothic vaults that once covered the nave. Rather than copying the lost vaults in stone, the design reinterprets them in a contemporary material, so the memory of the original space is felt without being imitated.

MATERIAL

Timber was chosen because it is sustainable, renewable and traditional. It stores carbon and has been used in building in this region for centuries. Its warmth contrasts clearly with the brick and stone of the church. All members share the same cross-section of 50 × 50 cm, built up from thin bonded layers of wood, which allows them to be bent into curves while staying strong enough to span the nave.

STRUCTURE

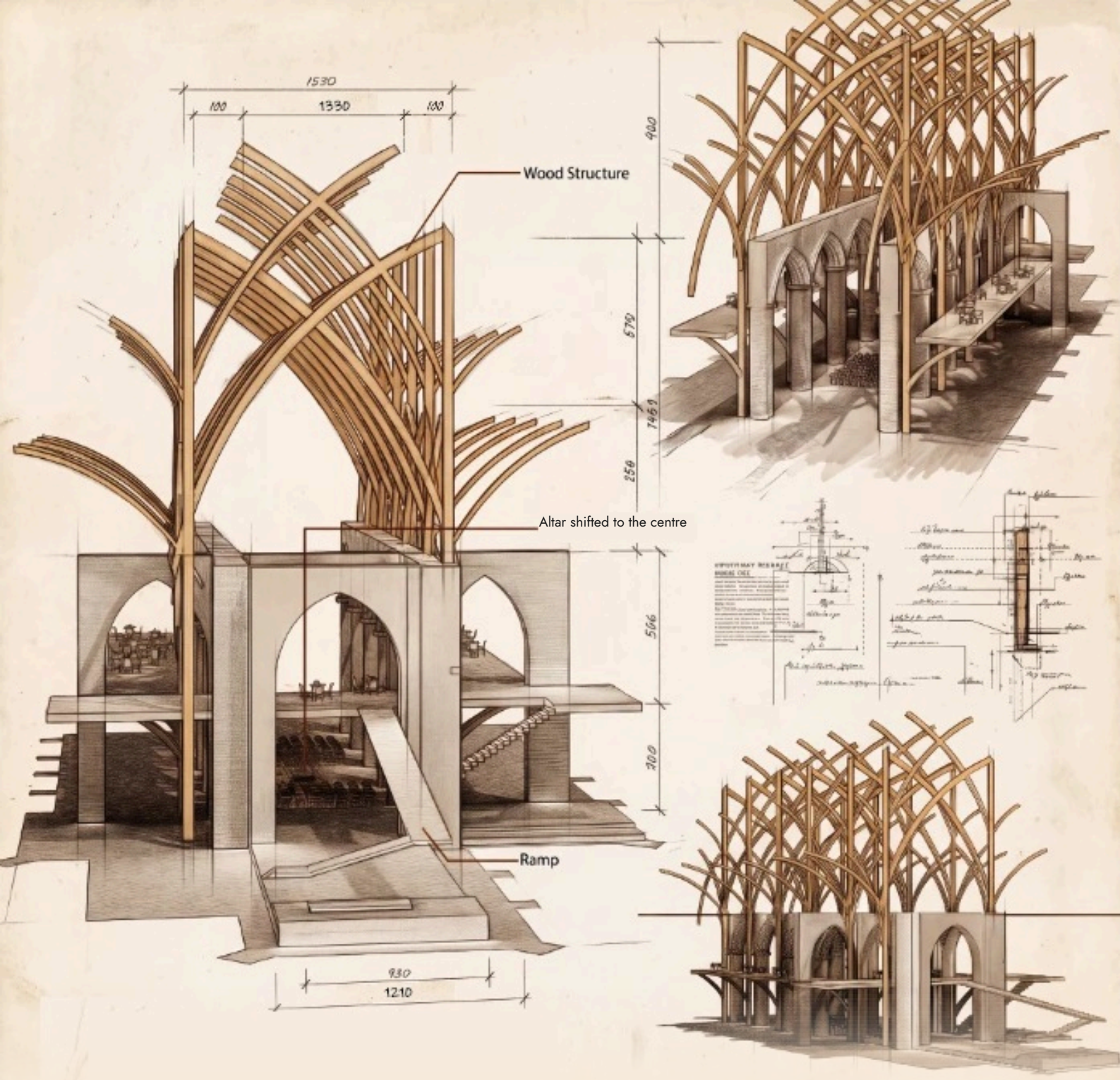
The timber trees carry the new roof above the historic walls. Curved brackets branch out from the trunks to support the gallery floors of the community library, and a ramp connects both levels for universal access. All loads travel through the trunks down to their own foundations, so the old walls carry no new loads.

OLD AND NEW

The structure stands entirely on its own. Old and new remain clearly readable: heavy brick and stone below, a light timber forest above. Because the historic fabric is not touched, the intervention is reversible and could be removed in the future, leaving the original church intact.

LIGHT

A band of glazing between the old walls and the new roof lets daylight into the nave. The branching ribs filter this light, casting changing patterns of light and shadow across the old walls, while the warm timber gives the ruin a welcoming atmosphere for worship, gathering and reading.



LEFT

Axonometric section: timber "trees" rise through the nave and carry the roof; brackets support the library gallery, and a ramp connects both levels.

CENTRE RIGHT

Detail: every timber member shares a cross-section of 50 × 50 cm, built up from thin bonded layers of wood.

TOP RIGHT

The canopy over the nave: crossing ribs form a forest of pointed arches above the historic arcade.

BOTTOM RIGHT

Side view: the timber canopy rises freely above the historic walls, touching none of the old fabric.



INTERIOR The timber canopy rises above the historic brick arcades, with the library gallery on both sides

02 · CHURCH REDESIGN

A Place to Gather

A historic church can remain a sacred space while becoming an active part of everyday community life.

New and old structures stand side by side, each readable on its own: heavy brick below, a light timber canopy above. Together they create a place where the town can gather throughout the day, the week and the year.



STREET VIEW The new roof rests on the timber structure above the old walls, with a band of light between them

03

Interwoven

Integration of Heritage into the Urban Fabric for Sustainable Development of Mymensingh

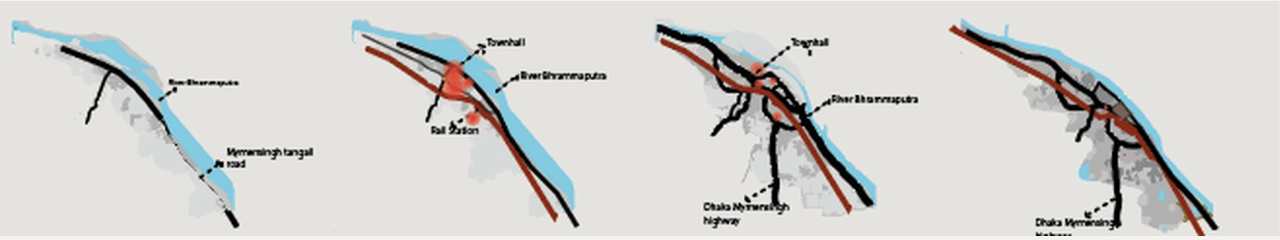
PROJECT	Bachelor's Thesis (B.Arch.)
ADVISOR	Dr. Sheikh Serajul Hakim
YEAR	2018
LOCATION	Mymensingh, Bangladesh

Current debates on sustainable urban development focus on technical issues such as carbon emissions and energy use, or on economic growth. This thesis asks what role heritage can play in making cities safe, sustainable and liveable.

CONTEXT	Mymensingh, one of the oldest districts of Bangladesh, is rich in tangible and intangible heritage, yet its historic buildings are deteriorating, its open spaces are inactive and the city has turned its back on the Brahmaputra river. Social life has become isolated from its roots, and the city is losing its identity.
AIM	To weave heritage back into the urban fabric: connecting historic buildings, open spaces and the river into one network that people use every day.

AERIAL VIEW The heritage-centred area opens to the Brahmaputra with a continuous riverside park

HISTORY



CHRONOLOGICAL GROWTH 1750–1800 · 1800–1900 · 1901–2000 · today: the city grows along the river, the railway and later the Dhaka–Mymensingh highway

GROWTH

Mymensingh, formerly known as Nasirabad, became one of the old districts of Bengal under the British East India Company in 1787. Over two centuries the town grew along the river, around landmarks such as the Old Town Hall, and later along the railway and highway, pushing its historic core and riverfront to the margins of daily life.

Reading the City

Heritage disconnected from its urban fabric



HERITAGE MAP Historic buildings across the city, between the river and the railway

STRENGTHS	Rich heritage, a craft industry and a city connected to the Brahmaputra
WEAKNESSES	Poor permeability, a weak visual character, inaccessible and inactive open spaces
OPPORTUNITIES	Tourism, several transport systems, open space as the city's breathing space
THREATS	Globalisation eroding historic value, heavy traffic, unhygienic walkways
ISSUES	The broad issue is that heritage has become disconnected from its urban fabric. In detail, there is no common platform for exploring heritage, the city is cut off from its river, and open space is scarce in the city core.



STUDY AREA Where the heritage core, the riverside and places of daily use overlap

A Heritage-Centred Plan

From the township to the single building



MASTER PLAN A heritage trail links historic buildings, open spaces and the riverside park

TOWNSHIP A heritage-centred area is defined from the city's history, overlapping its heritage core, the riverside and the places of daily use, and the river is reconnected to the city through recreation.

STUDY AREA Open spaces are distributed across the area, entries are defined and through traffic is discouraged. Mixed and overlapping uses, active building fronts and a walkable network bring different income groups together.

HERITAGE SITE Heritage buildings such as Shashi Lodge, Alexander Castle, Gauripur Lodge and Hasan Manzil are identified and given new uses, and new buildings around them respect their historic character.

CONCLUSION Heritage becomes part of the city's everyday life again: not a set of isolated monuments, but a connected network of buildings, open spaces and riverfront that gives Mymensingh back its identity.

Heritage is not a set of monuments to visit, but the fabric a city lives in.

From Issues to Design

The approach

Each problem facing Jatrapala was translated into an objective, then into design indicators and finally into concrete design variables, so that every spatial decision responds to a real need.

ISSUE	OBJECTIVE	DESIGN INDICATOR	DESIGN VARIABLE
DECLINING PUBLIC INTEREST	Attract the public to Jatra	Public gathering and open space	Shared platform; views from the road
LOSS OF TRADITIONAL VALUE	Revive and enrich the tradition	Performance platform; research; new generation	Training space; open stage and voids
LITTLE INTERACTION AMONG TROUPES	Increase interaction	Transparent functions; group activity	Connectivity; shared spaces



SITE PLAN The curved building wraps around a stepped, planted amphitheatre that descends to the round stage

04

Encore

A theatre in the round for Bengal's Jatrapala

PROJECT	"Caring for Culture" · Jatrapala Performance and Development Centre
ADVISOR	[ ]
YEAR	[ ]
LOCATION	Nikaton, Dhaka, Bangladesh

A performance and development centre for Jatrapala in the heart of Dhaka. Built around a round stage in the tradition of Jatra's open arena, it gives this centuries-old folk theatre a permanent platform to perform, rehearse, train and research.

CONTEXT

Jatrapala, rooted in the lives of ordinary people, has long served as entertainment, education and a means of social and political mobilisation. Today it is in danger: public interest is declining, the art form lacks exposure, and traditional culture is giving way to foreign trends.

SITE

The site in Nikaton lies almost at the heart of Dhaka, bordered by four residential areas, next to Bir Uttam Mir Shawkat Sarak and the Hatirjheel link road, a popular public destination.



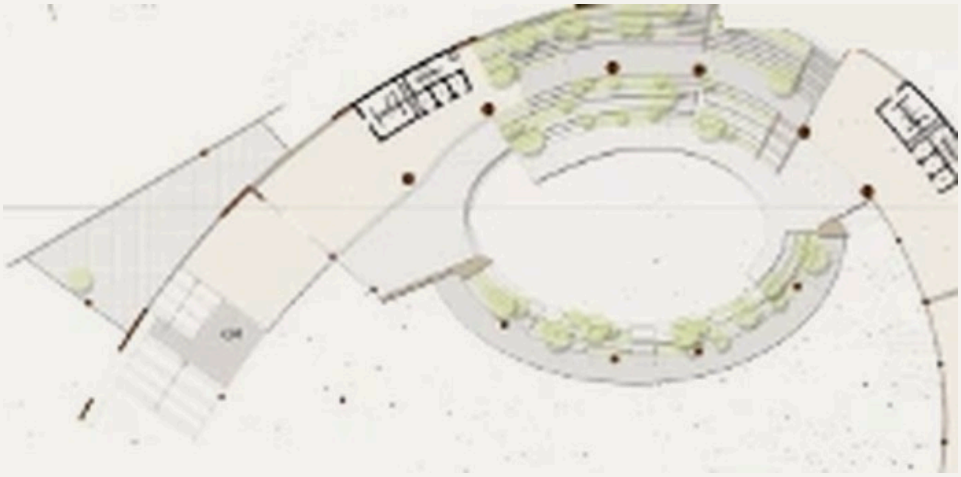
PERSPECTIVE The open-air amphitheatre, with stepped seating around a round stage and the tower behind

A Theatre in the Round

Performance at the heart of the building

DESIGN

Jatra is traditionally performed in the round: an open arena with the audience gathered on all sides of the stage. The design deliberately builds on this tradition. A circular open-air amphitheatre forms the heart of the building, its stepped seating sloping down towards a round stage, so that Jatra is performed here as it always has been. The curved wings wrap around this space, so rehearsal rooms, the library and workshops all look onto the performance below. A transparent tower with vertical fins marks the centre from the road, and a long bridge links the two wings across the courtyard.

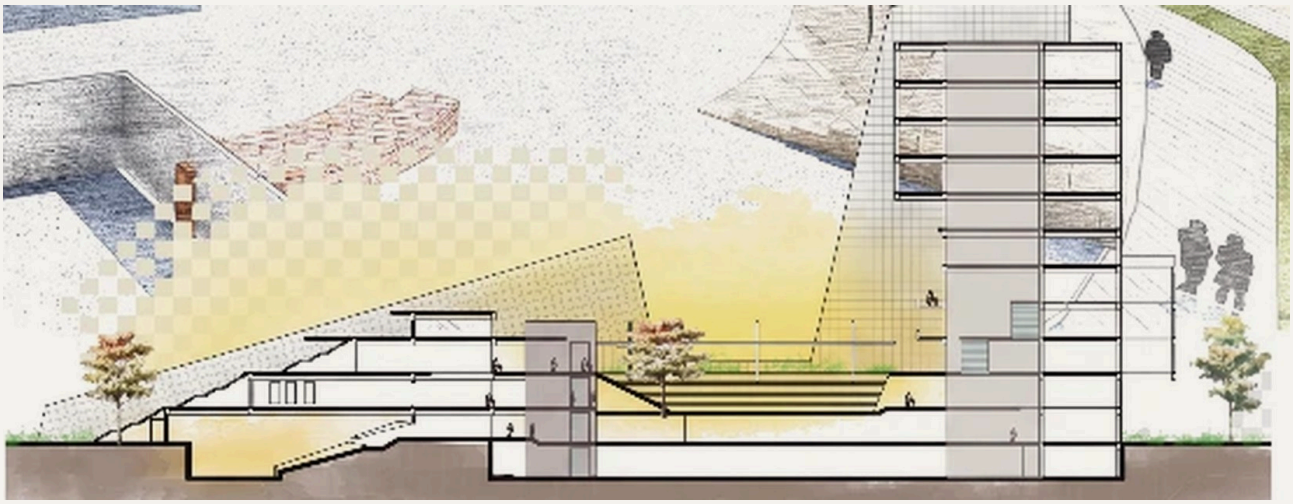


1ST FLOOR Curved wings wrapping around the central performance space



2ND FLOOR Rehearsal and library spaces overlooking the arena

PERSPECTIVE The open-air amphitheatre, with stepped seating around a round stage and the tower behind



SECTION From the sunken amphitheatre to the tower with workshop, offices and administration

05

Half-Timber Architecture

Documentation of Grudenberg 7, Halberstadt

PROJECT	Course “Organic Materials” · Master’s Programme
LECTURER	Claudia Hennrich
YEAR	Summer 2024
LOCATION	Grudenberg 7, Halberstadt, Saxony-Anhalt, Germany
TEAM	Group work with Afia Anjum Ulka Mony and Vishwa Shitalbhai Sheth

A building survey and construction analysis of a baroque half-timbered house. Through measured drawings of its plans, façades, sections and roof, the study traces how the timber frame is assembled, joint by joint, and compares it with Wordgasse 3 in Quedlinburg, one of the oldest houses of the town.

THE BUILDING

Built around 1690 as a residence near Halberstadt’s market square, the two-storey house has served many uses, from church services to a grain store on the upper floor. After the half-timbered floor collapsed in 1980, the first floor and roof were renewed with traditional craft techniques.

SURVEY

About 9 by 17 metres above a vaulted basement, the house is organised around a central hall with rooms on both sides and a baroque staircase at its western end. Twenty ceiling beams and six girders divide each floor into three bays, tied together by stitch beams along the gables.

HERO PHOTO · GRUDENBERG 7

GRUDENBERG 7 The baroque half-timbered house in Halberstadt, around 1690

WEST FAÇADE · MEASURED DRAWING

WEST FAÇADE Sill plates on a stone plinth, posts, rails and braces with red brick infill

Frame, Joints and Roof

Reading the construction

FRAME — The unplastered façades show the frame directly. Posts stand on sill plates and are tied by rails and braces with mortise-and-tenon joints; at each floor, the top plate, ceiling beam and sill plate above lock together in a comb joint.

ROOF — Full frames of rafter, collar beams, laying post, tension bolt and brace alternate with lighter regular frames of rafter and brace, usually two between each pair of full frames.



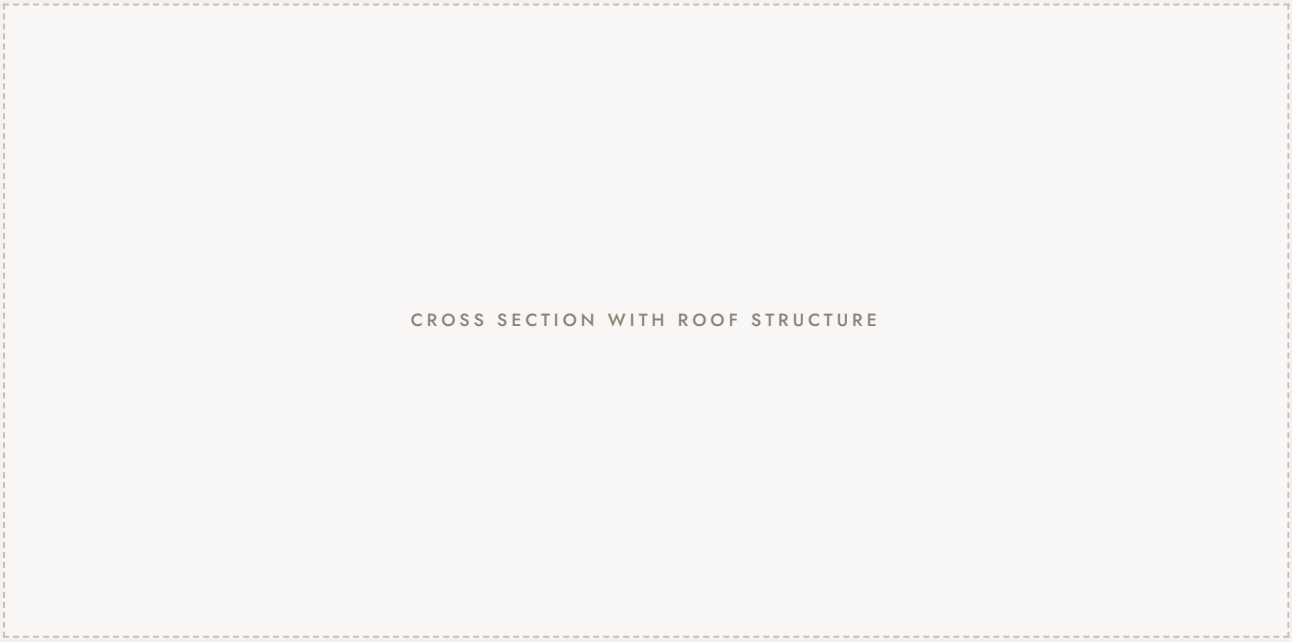
MORTISE AND TENON Post to sill plate, rail and top plate



COMB JOINT Top plate, ceiling beam and sill plate



LAP JOINT Brace lapped over a rail



CROSS SECTION East to west, from the stone plinth to the full roof frame

Two Ways of Framing

Compared with Wordgasse 3, Quedlinburg



WORDGASSE 3 Quedlinburg, 1347



GRUDENBERG 7 Halberstadt, around 1690

	WORDGASSE 3	GRUDENBERG 7
BUILT	1347	Around 1690
FRAME	Posts through both storeys	Framed storey by storey
JOINTS	Lap and dovetail joints	Comb joints, mortise and tenon
BRACING	Long braces crossing the storeys	Short braces between posts and plates
FAÇADE	Lime plaster	Exposed brick infill
ROOF	Posts, collar beams, one purlin	Full and regular frames

CONCLUSION Side by side, the two houses show how half-timber construction developed from continuous posts to storey-by-storey framing, and how much of a building's history can be read in its joints.